

Στράβων ὁ Ἀμασεύς

Strabo of Amasia and the Geography of the Known World

eul_aid: nck

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Γεωγραφία [Geography](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Strabo of Amasia was a Greek geographer, historian, and philosopher born around 64 or 63 BCE in Pontus. He lived until at least 23 CE. Born into a prominent family, he received an extensive education. He studied in Rome under figures like the geographer Tyrannion and the Peripatetic philosopher Xenarchus, and was influenced by Stoicism.

He traveled widely across the eastern Mediterranean and Egypt, utilizing the library at Alexandria. He wrote during the pivotal transition from the Roman Republic to the Empire under Augustus. His major surviving work is the *Geographica*, a 17-book descriptive geography of the Roman world. He also composed the *Historical Sketches* in 47 books, which continued the history of Polybius, but this work is now lost except for fragments.

Strabo's significance rests on the *Geographica*. It synthesizes earlier Greek geographical knowledge with his own observations and contemporary Roman sources. Blending history, ethnography, and myth, it served as a valuable resource for Roman administration and later geographers. The work provides an indispensable historical record of the ancient Mediterranean world.

Works (4)

- [Χρηστομάθειαι ἐκ τῶν Γεωγραφικῶν Στράβωνος](#) · [Chrestomathies from Strabo's Geographical Books](#) · 1667 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῶν Παρθικῶν Ἔθων](#) · [Fragments on Parthian Customs](#) · 19 passages
- [Γεωγραφικά](#) · [Geography](#) · 96 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 2 passages